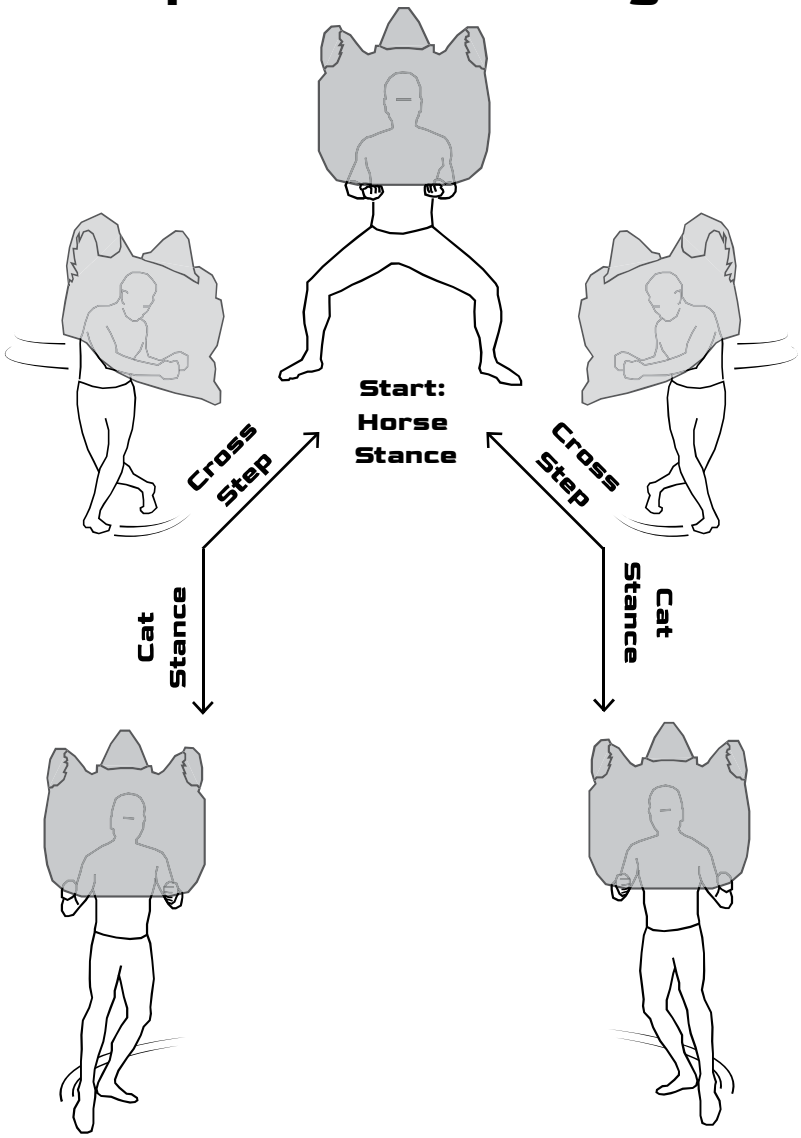
Sequence 4: 1/2 Octagon



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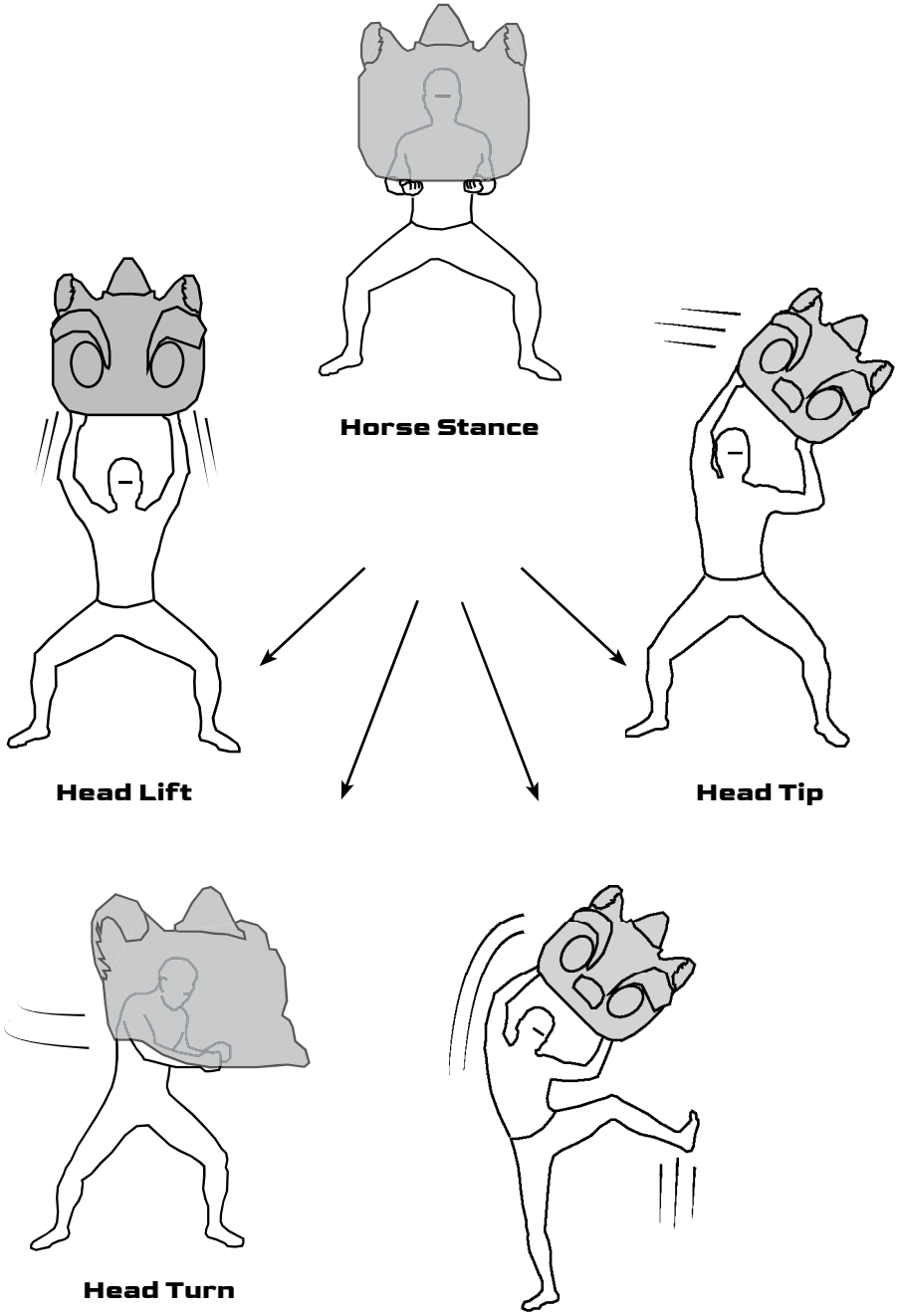
DRAGON AND CRANE DOJO

Traditional Karate
Adapted for Today

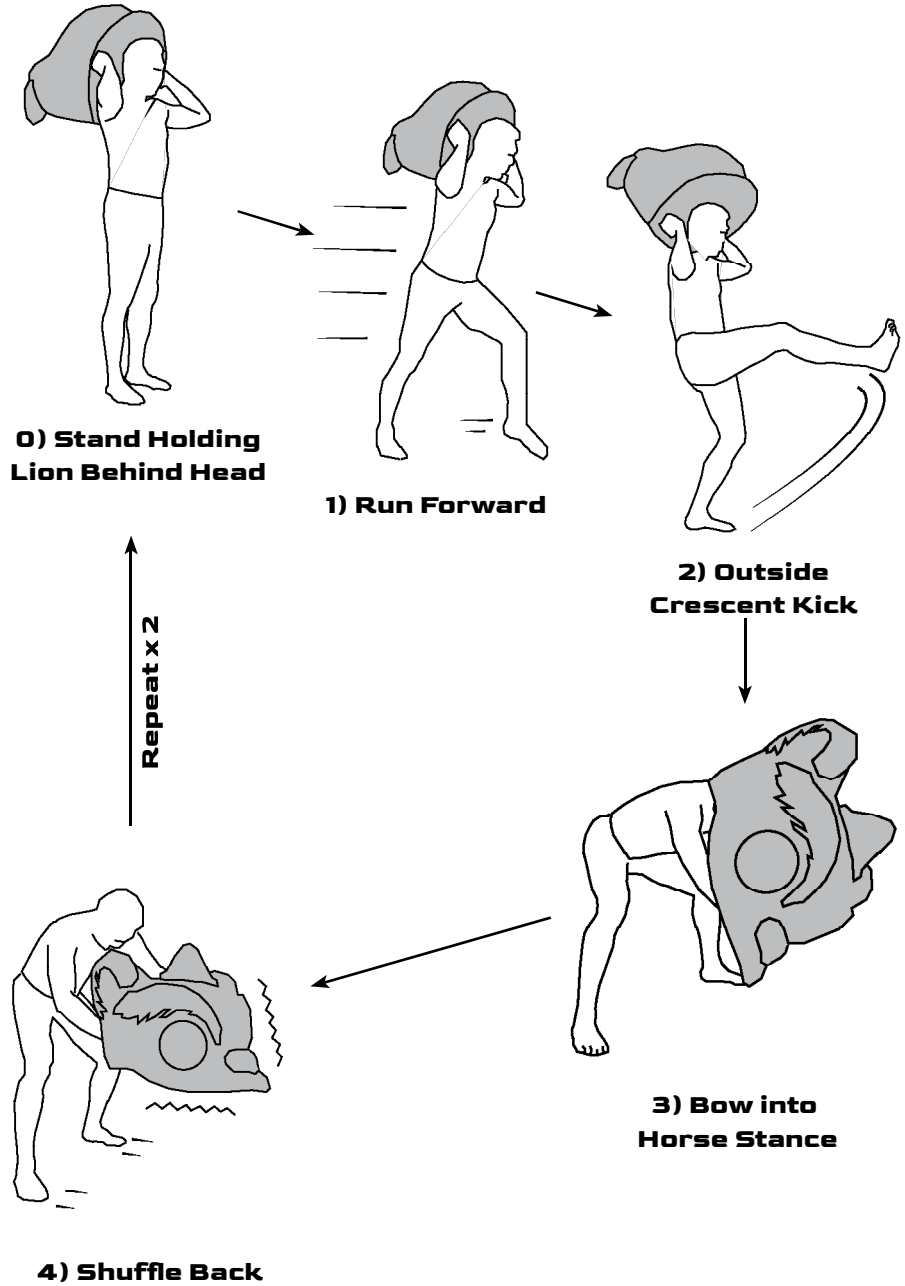
Theatrics Series

Lion Dancing

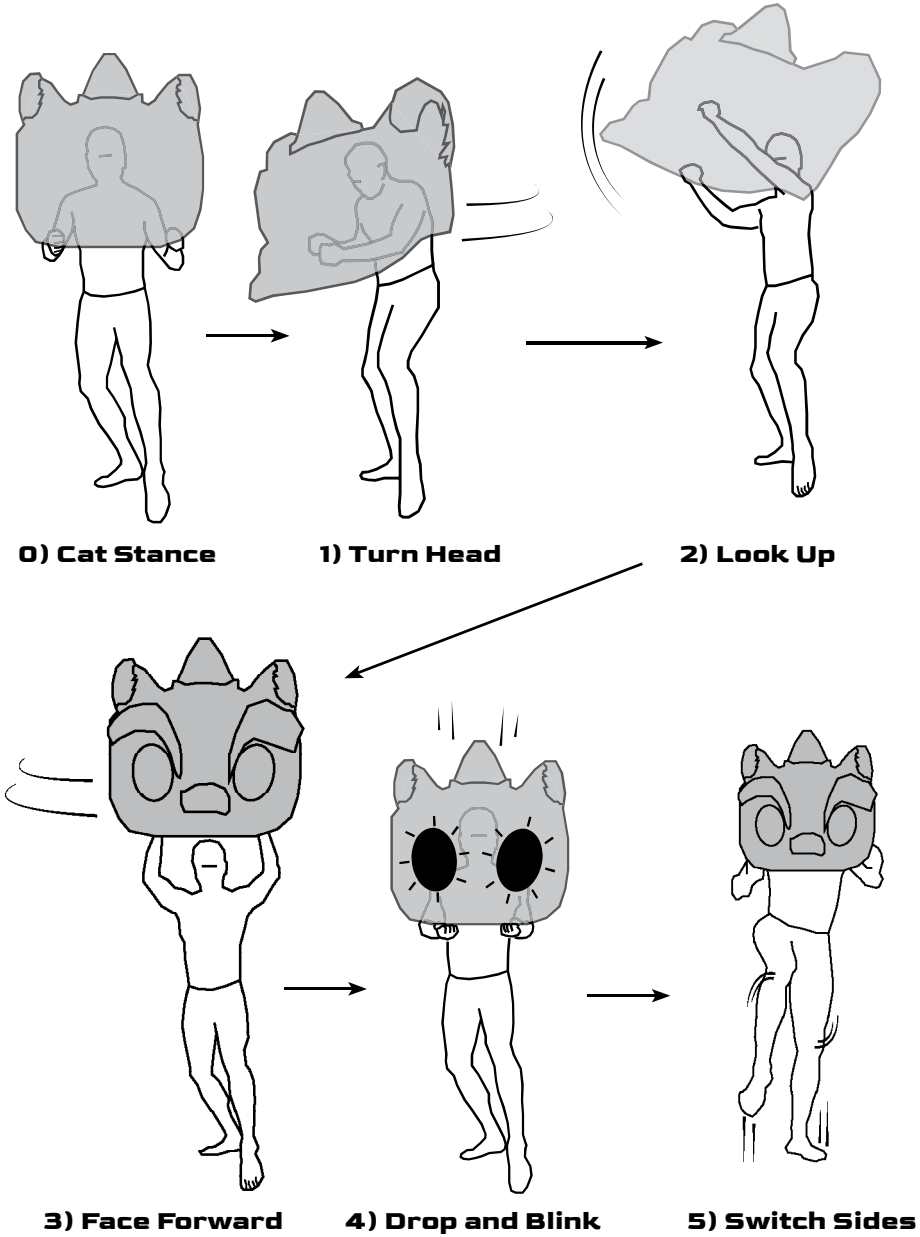
Move Set 1: Head



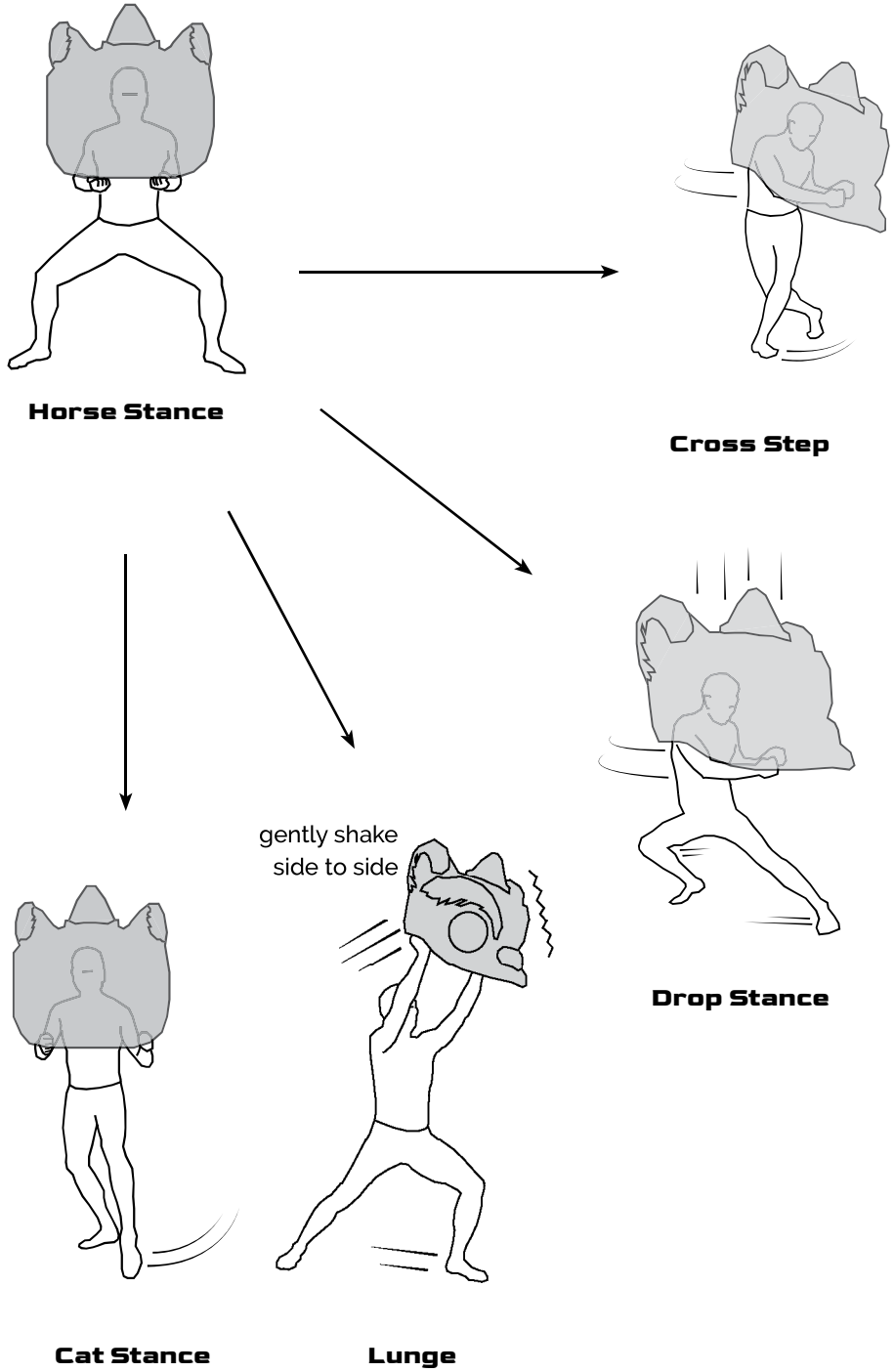
Sequence 3: Running Bow



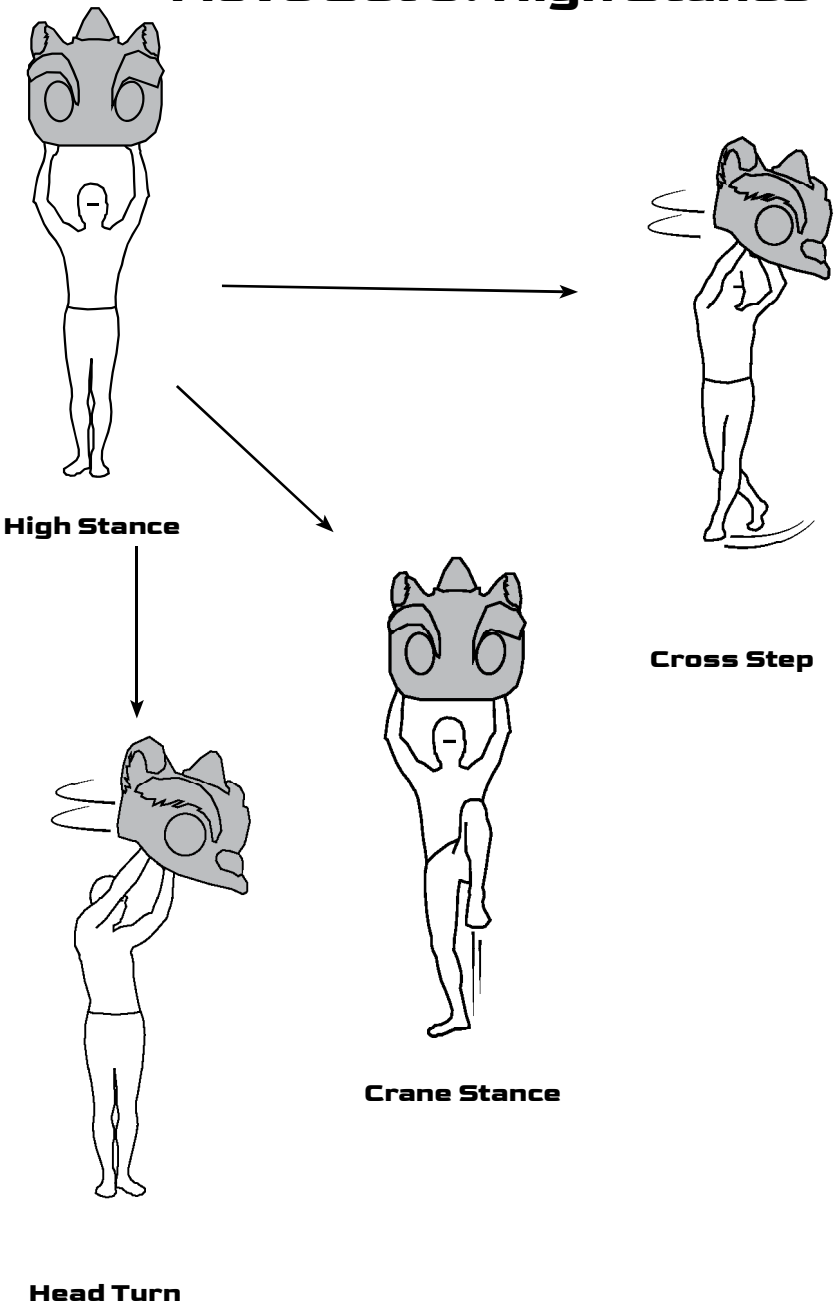
Sequence 2: Turning Bow



Move Set 2: Footwork



Move Set 3: High Stance



About Lion Dancing

Lion Dancing is one of the most iconic traditions of Lunar New Year. The lion would visit local houses and businesses door to door, accompanied by music. At each site they would "eat" lettuce containing a red envelope of money, in exchange for granting good fortune for the new year (Gong Xi Fa Cai).

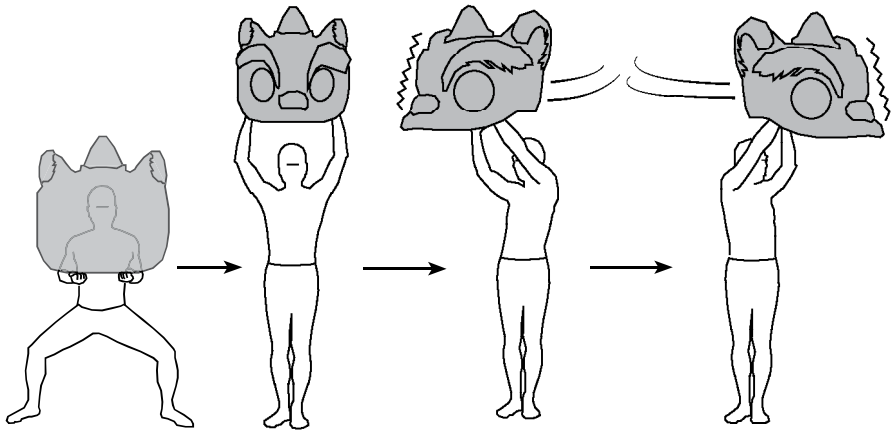
Lion Dancing takes skill, strength, and endurance, The troupe may have to walk long distances for over an hour, and would take turns to avoid fatigue. Therefore troupes usually came from kung fu or wushu (theatrical arts) schools.

The dance consists a mix of choreographed sequences for the start and at each store, but also featured extensive improvisation around basic sets of moves as the lions walked from door to door.

NOTE: many people mistakenly call the lion a "dragon". A lion is short, heavy, and held up by 2 people, while a dragon is long and held high on poles by many people. The lion is much, much harder to operate.

If you see a lion, show your appreciation by wishing it Gong Xi Fa Cai!

Sequence 1: Wake Up



0) Horse Stance **1) High Stance** **2) Shake Right to Left**